

Founders School House Week: Oct 19 to 25 (sample)

Sep 28, 2026 · @James Floyd

A sample week for Monday, October 19 to Sunday, October 25, 2026, built on the handbook’s weekly template. Students would choose between options at the Town Hall the Sunday before.

Disclaimer: the types of activities will be hugely affected by students interests and input.

This week’s statement piece: Five Boroughs, One Day. On Saturday the house runs a 5K in Brooklyn, walks the Brooklyn Bridge into Manhattan, rides the ferry to Staten Island, eats lunch on Arthur Avenue in the Bronx, and ends with dinner at the Queens Night Market. That’s all five boroughs, a 5K, and the free Staten Island Ferry, 25 minutes each way. The day costs about what the food costs.

Weeknights, 5 to 6:30pm

The hour between school and dinner is the practice block, and it should feel like play. Students have already spent the day on academics and their businesses. Here each student picks something they enjoy getting better at, that has nothing to do with their business: an instrument, a language, drawing, a sport, chess, poetry, cooking. No grades and no pressure.

Time	What happens
5:00 to 5:15	Home, a healthy snack (fruit, yogurt, eggs, nuts), a quick word with the RA
5:15 to 6:15	Practice block. Everyone practices at once, in the common room or the park.
6:15 to 6:30	Log the session: minutes and one number that shows progress (tempo, words learned, 5K time, pull-ups)

The log is posted in the house. Streaks and personal bests get called out at Sunday Town Hall, the same public status Alpha builds with its student-set standards. Friday has no practice block, because the house goes out.

Week at a glance

Day	Template slot	Plan	Dinner, 6:30pm	Families get
Mon Oct 19	Move: team	Practice block, then free open gym at Henry Street Settlement, 7 to 9pm	Crispy tofu with cashews and snap peas	Photos from open gym
Tue Oct 20	Cook	Practice block; cooking crew; house open mic after dinner	Moroccan-spiced chicken meatballs	Photo of the crew and the meal
Wed Oct 21	Rest, or hot takes night	Practice block, then a quiet night in: a hot takes night, board games, or group video games	Cheesy, spicy black bean bake	Nothing scheduled
Thu Oct 22	Move: solo skill	Free group run, Fleet Feet Columbus Circle, 6:30pm, in place of the practice block	Green curry salmon with coconut rice, after the run	Short check-in note
Fri Oct 23	Out	No practice block; Whitney Museum Free Friday Night	Sheet-pan bibimbap at 6pm, then out	Return time, then photos
Sat Oct 24	Statement piece	Five Boroughs, One Day	Queens Night Market	A live photo thread through the day
Sun Oct 25	Town Hall + week prep	God's Love We Deliver kitchen shift in the morning; Town Hall at 6pm	Sheet-pan chicken thighs with spicy corn	Weekly summary with the Town Hall log and practice-block numbers

Day by day

Monday: team. Henry Street Settlement runs free open gym at 301 Henry St for ages 16 to 19 from 7 to 9pm, and ages 12 to 15 from 5 to 7pm. Its Boys & Girls Republic gym at 888 E 6th St runs ages 16 to 19 from 7:30 to 9pm. To **confirm:** the page says "September to December" with no year. Call Luis Checa at 212-686-8888 x1924 about fall 2026 and a group of about 12. [Source](#)

Fallback: pickup basketball at Brooklyn Bridge Park's Pier 2 courts, free and first come, open 8am to 11pm. [Source](#)

Tuesday: cook. A crew of three or four cooks; the kitchen lead shopped on Sunday. After dinner, the house open mic in the common room: a poem of your own or one you love, three minutes each. It doubles as rehearsal for the Nuyorican open mic on October 30.

Wednesday: rest. Students work on their businesses all day. Tonight is a quiet night in, with a quick dinner. A hot takes night, board games, or group video games.

Thursday: solo skill. Fleet Feet's free group run leaves its Columbus Circle store Thursdays at 6:30pm, all paces welcome. [Source](#)

Once a month, over the weekly budget: climbing at Brooklyn Boulders Queensbridge, \$29 for a student day pass with student ID, plus \$6 each for shoes and a harness. [Source](#)

Friday: out. Whitney Museum Free Friday Nights, 5 to 10pm, free for everyone. Tickets are required and limited, so book now. [Source](#) Backup: the Met is open until 9pm on Fridays, pay what you wish for New York, New Jersey and Connecticut students and New York State residents. [Source](#)

Saturday: Five Boroughs, One Day.

Time	Borough	Stop	Cost
9:00am	Brooklyn	Brooklyn Bridge parkrun, a free 5K from Pier 1. No sign-up needed to run. Source	Free
10:00am	Manhattan	Walk the Brooklyn Bridge into Manhattan, then down to Whitehall Terminal	Free
11:00am	Staten Island	Staten Island Ferry past the Statue of Liberty, about 25 minutes each way; weekend boats every 30 minutes. Source	Free

Time	Borough	Stop	Cost
1:00pm	The Bronx	Lunch at the Arthur Avenue Market, the Bronx's Little Italy, open 8am to 8pm. Source	Lunch
4:30pm	Queens	Dinner at the Queens Night Market, Flushing Meadows Corona Park, 4pm to midnight; free entry, dishes capped at \$5 to \$6. Source	Dinner

Home by about 9pm. Each borough gets a group photo for the family thread. The outing routine from handbook section 9 runs all day, with a headcount at every stop.

Sunday: Town Hall. Sunday morning: a kitchen shift at God's Love We Deliver, which cooks and delivers meals to New Yorkers living with serious illness. It takes groups of up to 30 on Sundays. Students 16 and 17 can volunteer on their own; students 13 to 15 need a parent or guardian with them, so younger students cook Sunday dinner for the house instead. Book through its group form. [Source](#) Then laundry and rest. Optional: the Whitney is free every day for anyone 25 and under, 10:30am to 6pm, with a timed ticket. [Source](#) Town Hall at 6pm, then dinner.

Every outing runs the handbook's routine (section 9): headcount out and back, buddy pairs, a named meeting point, and the return time sent to the parent group.

Dinners

Six dinners at home from NYT Cooking, built for protein: three meat or fish, three vegetarian with a real protein at the center. Saturday is the Queens Night Market. Each recipe serves about four, so double or triple for the house.

Night	Recipe	Author	Main protein	Check for
Mon	Crispy Tofu With Cashews and Blistered Snap Peas	Yewande Komolafe	Tofu (vegetarian)	Soy, tree nuts, wheat, coconut
Tue	Moroccan-Spiced Chicken Meatballs	Lidey Heuck	Ground chicken	Dairy, wheat, possibly eggs
Wed	Cheesy, Spicy Black Bean Bake	Ali Slagle	Black beans and cheese (vegetarian)	Dairy

Night	Recipe	Author	Main protein	Check for
Thu	Green Curry Salmon With Coconut Rice	Melissa Clark	Salmon	Fish; curry paste can contain shellfish; coconut
Fri	Sheet-Pan Bibimbap	Eric Kim	Eggs (vegetarian)	Eggs, soy, sesame
Sun	Sheet-Pan Chicken Thighs With Spicy Corn	Melissa Clark	Chicken thighs	Dairy, if butter is used

Backups. For a nut allergy on Monday: [Red Lentil Soup](#). For a second fish night: [One-Pot Ginger Salmon and Rice](#).

The "Check for" column lists the allergens each dish is likely to contain. The kitchen lead checks every ingredient list against the house allergy file (handbook section 7) before shopping. NYT Cooking needs a subscription and blocked automated checks, so read cooking times and servings on each recipe page. Each link was confirmed on at least one other site that cites it, such as [Eat Your Books](#) and [The Dinner Plan](#).

Cost per student

Item	Cost
Open gym, group run, Whitney, parkrun, Staten Island Ferry	Free
Arthur Avenue lunch and Queens Night Market dinner	About \$15 to \$25 of food; the market caps dishes at \$5 to \$6
Events total	Food on Saturday, plus subway fares

Before the week

- ☐ Book Whitney free tickets for Friday, October 23.
- ☐ Call Henry Street to confirm fall open gym and a group of 12.
- ☐ Check Fleet Feet's Instagram for the October 22 run.

- ☐ Announce Five Boroughs, One Day at the Town Hall the Sunday before, so students can train for the 5K.
- ☐ Confirm photo consent is on file for everyone in pictures.
- ☐ Send families the week's plan by Sunday, October 18.
- ☐ Bring cash for Saturday; the Queens Night Market is mostly cash.
- ☐ Plan the Saturday subway legs from the residence once the address is known.
- ☐ Book the God's Love We Deliver group shift for Sunday, October 25.

Statement pieces for the year

One big shared challenge a month, the kind students tell their families about for years. They rotate between moving, performing, hosting, serving, teaching and building. Every date and age rule below was checked on September 28.

When	Type	Statement piece	Cost	Minors	Book by
Fri Oct 30, 2026	Perform	Every student reads a poem at the Nuyorican Poets Cafe's Final Friday event at Loaisida Center, East 9th St. The Tuesday house open mics are the rehearsals.	Not listed	The Nuyorican says its events have no age restrictions	Check the Nuyorican calendar for sign-up. Schedule · Age policy
Sun Nov 1, 2026	Serve	Volunteer at the TCS New York City Marathon, handing water to runners	Free	13 and up, per volunteer groups that have signed up (NYRR's own page could not be checked)	Now: group sign-ups may be closing. Source
Any Saturday in November	Move	Walk the length of Manhattan, about 13.4 miles from Inwood Hill Park to Battery Park	Free	House-run	No booking. Source

When	Type	Statement piece	Cost	Minors	Book by
Mid-November	Host	Salon dinner. The house plans the menu, cooks, sets a formal table and invites six guests: founders, artists, a professor. Each student leads one conversation over the meal.	Groceries	House-run	Invite guests three weeks ahead
Early December, before break	Host	The house plans, funds and runs a community night for neighbors, day students and families: dinner cooked by the house, the practice-block showcase, and a guest speaker. Students own the budget, invitations and run of show.	Set by students	House-run	Pick the date by November 1; check whether the venue needs a permit
Any Saturday	Serve	Feed the city: a City Harvest Mobile Market shift, 8:30am to noon	Free	14 and up; one adult per four minors; guardian-signed waiver	Two weeks ahead. Source
January	Perform	Candlelit poetry and music evening at the house. Each student recites or plays one piece for invited families and guests.	Free	House-run	Send invitations a month ahead
Winter term	Teach	Each student teaches a free one-hour class on their practice-block skill to younger kids, at a library branch or community center	Free	House-run with the host site	Ask the host site a month ahead

When	Type	Statement piece	Cost	Minors	Book by
February	Host	Student-curated exhibition. Each student shows one piece of work (photographs, writing, a prototype, a painting) with a written placard, and the house hosts an opening night with a short welcome from each artist.	Printing and framing, set by students	House-run	Send invitations a month ahead
March	Perform	Oxford-style debate before an invited audience. Two teams argue a real motion chosen at Town Hall, and the audience votes before and after.	Free	House-run	Pick the motion a month ahead
Sat Mar 20, 2027	Move	Fight for Air Climb: 55 stories, 1,099 steps at PENN 1	Not listed	Not confirmed	Source
Sat May 1, 2027	Move	The Great Saunter: 32 miles around the whole shoreline of Manhattan in one day	\$35 in 2026	Allowed with an adult who takes full responsibility; register as a youth group	Registration opens February. Source
Sun May 2, 2027	Move	TD Five Boro Bike Tour: 40 miles, car-free, through all five boroughs	\$187	14 to 17 ride their own bikes with a registered adult	Open now. Source
Late spring	Move	Sail the Hudson as a crew after a series of private lessons with Hudson River Community Sailing in Chelsea	\$500 per 2-hour private lesson, up to 5 people	Group lessons are 18+; private lessons are the exception	Ask about spring dates in March. Source

When	Type	Statement piece	Cost	Minors	Book by
End of the school year	Build	Publish a bound book of the house's writing and photographs from the year, with a launch reading at an independent bookstore	Printing, set by students	House-run with the store	Ask the store two months ahead
Last Friday of each term	Perform	Showcase night: every student shows what they built in the practice block	Free	House-run	Invite families a month ahead

Waivers. Several of these require a parent or legal guardian to sign or attend. Collect signed consent for the year's statement pieces at move-in, and ask each organizer whether a notarized parental waiver lets the RA stand in.

The Empire State Building Run-Up is 18 and over, so it is out. [Source](#)

Not available this week

- Free kayaking has ended for the season: the Downtown Boathouse closed October 4 and the Manhattan Community Boathouse closes October 11.
- Citi Bike requires riders to be 16 or older and costs \$25 a day, so it does not work for a mixed-age group. [Source](#)
- Group play on Hudson River Park fields needs a permit filed 21 days ahead. [Source](#)
- The Nuyorican Poets Cafe's Final Friday Slam falls on October 30, the following week.